

Elleta McDaniel

Design Engineer · Design Systems

Barcelona, Spain Open to Hybrid/Remote

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Profile

Design engineer who works where design meets code. I build token architectures, component libraries and the governance and documentation that keep them true in production, and I make them readable by AI as well as by people. I use Claude, Figma MCP and Code Connect daily to audit, document and ship faster, and I read the code so design and engineering stay aligned. Background in front-end development and product design for complex B2B SaaS, fintech and institutional platforms.

Employment

Oct 2025 to
Present

AI-Enabled Design Systems Engineer @ Brad Frost Web (Maker Program) · Contract

- Build Claude-powered workflows for prototyping, component audits and system documentation.
- Built a Figma component library aligned with reusable web components and a multi-theme architecture, translating an existing code-based system into production-ready Figma components.
- Shape governance, documentation and design-to-code alignment, applying Atomic Design across HTML, CSS, JavaScript and static-site tooling.

Oct 2025 to
Present

Design Systems Consultant @ elleta.design

Design Systems Specialist @ a global fashion retailer · Apr 2026 to Jul 2026

- Owned component governance for the retailer's cross-platform design system across Web, iOS and Android: defined, governed and released components across shared Figma libraries, documented in Zeroheight.
- First to bring AI into the team's design-system work: built workflows with Claude, Figma MCP and the Desktop Bridge for automated audits, machine-readable component patterns and documentation.
- Built the tooling and docs the team needed to adopt Code Connect themselves, so design-to-code parity didn't depend on me.
- Ran accessibility and dark-mode audits; defined metrics for adoption, coverage, efficiency and quality.

UX / Product Designer @ UN Office at Geneva (UNOG) · Oct 2025 to Dec 2025

- Designed a high-fidelity operational dashboard prototype across multiple teams, turning complex workflows into clear data visualisation.
- Ran stakeholder interviews with technical and non-technical users; designed modular components and layouts for a scalable, accessible dashboard.

Jul 2024 to Feb
2026

Product & Design Systems Designer @ a B2B travel platform

- Built the company's first design system from scratch (tokens, components, themes) and integrated the tokens into production code with engineering; wrote the documentation from day one.
- Led the UX transformation of a legacy platform across booking, admin, finance and multi-role dashboards.
- Re-architected and shipped end-to-end booking for flights and car rental: search, filters, sorting, seat selection, upsells and post-booking, within API and edge-case constraints.

- Ran research with clients and shipped the features they requested.
- Delivered prototypes for executive and investor presentations that supported funding for product and team growth.

Feb 2023 to
Feb 2024

UX/UI Designer @ VML

- Designed mobile-native banking experiences on a client team, from wireframes to high-fidelity prototypes.
- Ran UX research, benchmarking and usability evaluations; worked with product managers and developers on consistent, accessible implementation.

Feb 2022 to
Mar 2022

Frontend Developer @ Co.Lab

Jun 2022 to
Sep 2022

DevOps Engineer @ Allianz Technology

Dec 2020 to
Jan 2022

Client Account Manager @ ADP

2011 to 2020

Earlier career

- Project Partner Manager, HP (2014 to 2020)
- Junior Fashion Designer, ecological fashion brand internship (2016)
- B2B & Consumer Sales Representative, Apple (2011 to 2013)

Projects

BELLA

My open design system: token pipeline, React components in Storybook, visual and contract tests, and docs written for people and AI (MCP-readable). Powers elleta.design.

CHIP

A design-system agent built solo in five days for the Anthropic Claude Code hackathon: it watches for drift, drafts fixes and waits for approval.

Skills

Design systems

Token architecture Component APIs Governance and contribution
Documentation Adoption metrics Accessibility (WCAG 2.2 AA)

AI workflows

Claude / Claude Code Figma MCP Code Connect AI-readable docs

Build

Figma (advanced) Storybook React TypeScript HTML/CSS
Next.js Git

Product

Research and usability testing Information architecture
Complex B2B flows Multi-role dashboards

Credentials

2024 to 2025

Brad Frost Web Maker Program
Brad Frost

2025

Design Tokens Course
Romina Kavčič, The Design System Guide

2025 to 2026	Into Design Systems (conference) Into Design Systems
2025	Smart Interface Design Patterns (workshop) Vitaly Friedman, Smashing Magazine
2026	Designing Complex UIs in the Age of AI (workshop) Vitaly Friedman, Smashing Magazine
2026	Claude Code hackathon Anthropic
Education	
Nov 2022 to Jan 2023	Ironhack UX/UI Design
Apr 2021 to Jan 2022	SheCodes Frontend Developer, Information Technology
2012 to 2013	IDEP Barcelona Postgraduate, Fashion Design and Image
2005 to 2009	Arizona State University BSc Design, Interior Architecture, 3.9 GPA